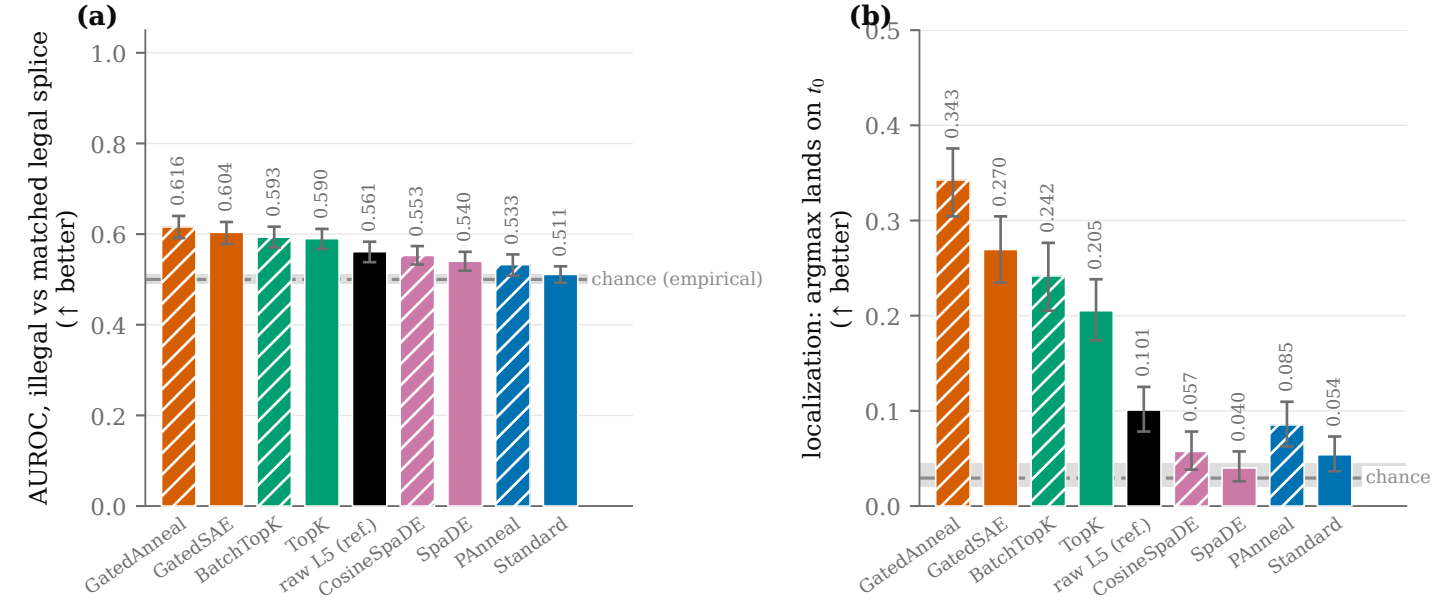

Score: how much shorter than usual the step through the space is, standardized per move index against legal games, then contrasted across each candidate move (MOSUM, m = 4 plies before and after) and scanned blind over the whole game -- no knowledge that a move was spliced, and no counterfactual branch. The window was chosen on the straightness violation corpus, whose splices differ. One illegal branch per game at seed 42; whiskers are 95% percentile bootstrap CIs over 575 games (1,000 resamples). (a) AUROC of the illegal branch's peak against the same game's legal-splice branch; AUROCs are never flipped, so a bar at 0.5 is the finding, and the 4 dictionaries above raw also clear it on the paired difference (+0.029 to +0.054, none spanning zero). (b) exact-match rate over a 34-candidate scan; within one ply it is 0.485 at best and 0.301 for raw, whose argmax lands on t_0 and t_0+1 equally often. Gray bands are empirical nulls: (a) each game's legal control against the second legal control it carries, (b) the same two arms and the untouched reference game, none of which contain an illegal move.